Times health

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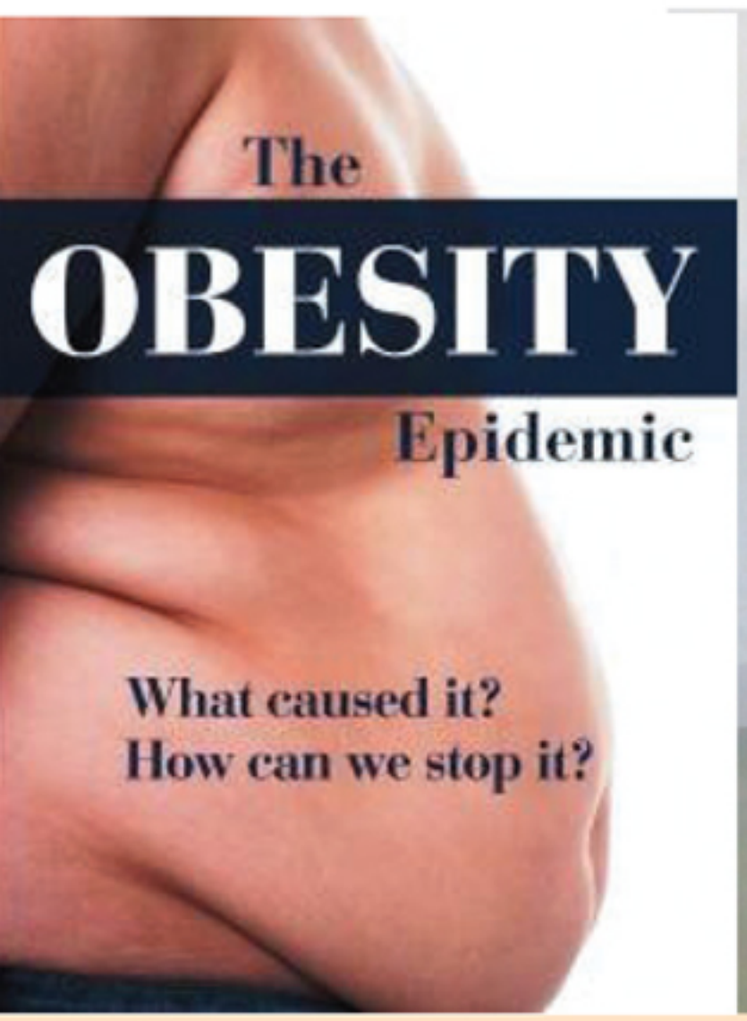

Dr. K Sendhil Kumar

"UNDERWEIGHT WAS A KILLER, OVERWEIGHT NOW A MURDERER"

With tension furrows on her forehead and depressed voice a lady approached us in our OP at Gateway clinics and asked us "Doctor would you please help me and my family?" Reaching into the depth of matter she opened up that her only daughter, who is 24 years old finished her college, is suffering from high Blood Pressure since 1 year at this young age and I'm very much worried regarding her marriage issue, as so many alliances said "NO" to marry her, and the only single reason was her weight.....148 kilograms!! We, the gateway team members were the happiest people in the gathering of this girl's marriage function after two years of laparoscopic obesity surgery , to see her in a bridal costume with a smile and confidence with her present weight 75 kgs.

Obesity once thought to be a cosmetic problem alone now has become social, medical problem which has reached epidemic proportions globally. India is facing "Double burden" of Obesity, says Chairman & eminent Laparoscopic Surgical Gastroenterologist of Gateway Clinics Dr. K. Sendhilkumar.

Although there are genetic and hormonal influences on body weight, obesity occurs when you take in more calories than you burn through exercise and normal daily activities. Your body stores these excess calories as fat. Obesity usually results from a combination of causes and contributing factors, including: Sedentary life,Unhealthy diet and eating habits, Lack of sleep, certain medications include some anti-depressants, anti-seizure , diabetes , antipsychotic , steroids, Medical problems such as Cushing's syndrome, polycystic ovary syndrome, hypothyroidism can also lead to obesity

People can reduce the obesity burden by limiting the energy intake in diet, increase consumption of fruit and vegetables, as well as legumes whole grains. And engage in regular physical activity at least 60 minutes a day.

Today, bariatric (obesity) surgery has been given green signal as a safe and effective weight loss treatment when other methods have failed. Surgery improves quality of life, social interactions, psychological well being, employment opportunities and economic condition beside the positive health improvement.

To know whether a person is a candidate for obesity surgery we follow strict established guidelines that is He or she has failed other conservative weight loss alternatives, such as supervised diet, exercise and behavior modification programs, at least 18 years of age, have a BMI (Body mass index) of at least 37, or have a BMI of at least 32 with one or more serious obesity related conditions like diabetes, high Blood Pressure, infertility, sleep apnea etc.

BMI can easily be calculated by formula = weight (in kilograms)/ Square of Height (in meters)

Operation for treating Obesity is being performed laparoscopically which enjoys benefit of less pain, shorter hospital stay, no external stitches or scar, early return to normal routine work and office. The types of surgery are restrictive, malabsorptive or combined depends on the extent of disease.

To know whether weight loss surgery is right for you, call us- 0422-2542244, 09245731318

Or meet us at Gateway clinics, Department of obesity and metabolic surgery, Coimbatore.

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